



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

PATIENT BALANCE & REVENUE-CYCLE RECOVERY · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Receivables Recovery for Medical Practices

Recovering aged patient-responsibility balances across all 22 locations — on pure contingency

Prepared for **Pace Foot and Ankle Centers** · August 2026

The balances your billing platform can see but can't finish

To the Pace Foot and Ankle Centers revenue-cycle team — you told us your aging is concentrated at **90+ days** and that you're evaluating third-party collections. That profile is familiar. A unified billing platform across 22 locations gets claims out cleanly and works insurance well; what it can't do is chase the patient-responsibility layer that piles up behind it — deductibles and coinsurance on surgical and wound-care episodes, DME and orthotics balances, and the self-pay remainder after benefits. Those accounts don't fail because the billing is wrong. They sit because nobody has the capacity to keep working them once the claim is closed.

Aged patient balances are a revenue-cycle problem, not a billing problem. The care was delivered, the claim was adjudicated, the statement went out — and then the balance ages. Every month past 90 days, addresses go stale, phone numbers change, and the likelihood of recovery falls. A centralized business office can only push so far before the cost of chasing exceeds the balance.

Southwest Recovery Services has worked receivables on **pure contingency since 2004**, with recovery reach across all 50 states. We've collected millions of dollars in industries just like yours since 2004. You place accounts through a secure portal that takes your billing export, and we work them — compliantly, discreetly, and in a tone that protects the physician-patient relationship your owners built the network to preserve. No recovery, no fee.

Two decades of receivables recovery — nationwide

A track record built on high-volume patient and commercial receivables and a documented, compliant process — an extension of your central business office that you don't have to hire, train or manage.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004

Nationwide — all 50 states

12 offices across 7 states

Skip tracing on businesses & principals

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY

FINANCIAL SERVICES
Review

FSR • TOP 10 LIST
2025 Recognition

INTERNATIONAL
Business Times

CFO Tech
Outlook

insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



 ★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

What a multi-site practice asks before placing patient balances

Direct answers on cost, on how patients are treated, on the 90+ aging you described, and on what placement asks of your billing team.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. Fee structure	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no monthly minimum. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover. The rate scales with the age, balance and volume you place, and we quote it once we've seen a representative sample of your aging.
2. How patients are treated	Firm, respectful, and discreet. No threats, no misrepresentation, no pressure tactics. FDCPA and Reg F requirements are enforced inside the workflow, consent and phone checks run before outreach, and every contact is documented — so if a patient calls a practice upset, your staff can see exactly what was said and when. Your physicians keep seeing these patients; we work accordingly.
3. A book that is mostly 90+	That aging mix is exactly the work. Older balances need more than statements: current address and phone verification, skip tracing on patients who have moved, and persistent multi-channel contact rather than another letter to a stale address. Recovery on aged paper is lower than on fresh — we will tell you honestly what a 90+ book should be expected to return before you place anything.
4. Placement & your billing platform	Low-lift by design. Bulk-upload an aging export from your unified billing platform through our portal, or place by secure SFTP/API — we map your columns, so there is no re-keying and no new workflow for your billing staff. Work begins within 24–48 hours of a documented placement. We also handle outsourced AR management and insurance follow-up if you want balances worked before they reach third-party placement.

Billing-platform-ready intake and full visibility, on demand

Every placement is managed through our secure portal — built to take your billing exports and give a centralized business office live, self-service access across every location.

BILLING-PLATFORM-READY PLACEMENT

Upload an aging export from your practice management or billing system — we map your columns, no re-keying.

SECURE FILE EXCHANGE

Send EOBs, itemized statements, financial-responsibility forms and correspondence safely inside the portal — the documentation that resolves disputes fast.

REPORTING BY DIVISION AND LOCATION

Run and export recovery reports on demand across all 22 locations and six divisions — a live dashboard, not a monthly PDF.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments a patient makes at the front desk, so balances stay accurate and no one is contacted about money they already paid.

► [Portal Video Tour](#)

SWRS Patient-Balance Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's healthcare book, anonymized by sector. Shown honestly: recovery tracks the age of the paper, and a book placed mostly at 90+ behaves like the lower end of this range, not the top.

SURGICAL HOSPITAL

Elective & scheduled procedures

\$184K recovered

of ~\$446K placed

41% recovered

DIAGNOSTIC IMAGING

PROVIDER

Outpatient imaging

\$25K recovered

of ~\$48K placed

51% recovered

DERMATOLOGY PRACTICE

Patient-responsibility balances

\$31K recovered

of ~\$69K placed

45% recovered

MULTI-SITE PHYSICIAN

GROUP

Specialty practice network

\$269K recovered

of ~\$1.26M placed

21% recovered

HIGH-VOLUME DERMATOLOGY

GROUP

4,400+ patient accounts

\$160K recovered

of ~\$1.04M placed

15% recovered

EMERGENCY & HOSPITAL

MEDICINE

Self-pay after benefits

\$545K recovered

of ~\$3.40M placed

16% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

THE AGE CURVE

Why aged patient balances behave differently

A patient balance is most collectible while the episode of care is recent and the contact information on file is still good. Past 90 days, patients move, numbers change, and the memory of the visit fades — which is why the same practice can see very different results depending only on when it places.

WHAT AGING COSTS YOU

Balances placed inside 90 days routinely outperform the same book placed a year later by a wide margin — the paper doesn't change, the reachability does.

THE STANDING RULE

A fixed “place at 90 days” policy recovers materially more than letting balances drift toward write-off — and on contingency there's no cost to placing.

Recovery figures vary by portfolio; SWRS gives an honest, age-based read on a representative sample before any accounts are worked.

We speak your revenue cycle

A 22-location, six-division podiatry network on a single billing platform has a specific recovery profile. Our playbook is built for exactly that.



The self-pay layer after benefits

Deductibles, coinsurance and the patient remainder on surgical, wound-care and orthotics episodes — the balances that survive a clean claim and then age.



Patients who have moved on

Address and phone verification plus skip tracing on patients who relocated after the episode of care — the single biggest reason aged medical balances go uncollected.



One relationship, every division

Foot & Ankle Center, Delaware County, Greenfield, Sutera and Jones, Your Next Step and PA Foot & Ankle worked under one agreement and one portal — with reporting that still separates them.



Physician autonomy preserved

Your owners built this network to keep practices independent. Recovery runs centrally without putting a single physician's name behind a collection call.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right approach reaches the right patient first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, voice and mailed notices, timed to when a patient is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account, and handled with the discretion a medical balance requires.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation and recovery performance across all 22 locations in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement straight off your billing platform means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention on the balances most likely to be paid.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for Pace Foot and Ankle Centers

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Patient AR — The Cost of Waiting

Aged patient balances · PDF

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Medical Debt Compliance

FDCPA / Reg F / credit reporting · PDF

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The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

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The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

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The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

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Let's put a real number against your 90+ aging.

A 30-minute call to walk a representative sample of your patient-responsibility balances — by age, by division and by balance size — confirm the export handoff from your billing platform, and put a contingency rate against it.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

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12 offices across 7 states · nationwide recovery. Private & confidential — prepared for Pace Foot and Ankle Centers. FDCPA / CFPB / FCRA compliant · ACA International member.